

# **Student Based Resource Allocations MOU**

## **Final Report**

### **November 2016**

#### **Executive Summary:**

This MOU was developed during Consensus Based Bargaining in 2014. It results from a survey of hundreds of BVSD educators across the district who expressed strong interest in developing a weighted student allocation method that would effectively provide differentiated support to address the needs of all students and communities across BVSD.

#### **MOU:**

The purpose of this MOU is to establish the parameters of an ongoing work group charged with using professional judgment and research/experts to facilitate as needed, in order to determine appropriately differentiated student based allocations of school resources in BVSD; to ensure that all schools have an equitable playing field, and make recommendations for the allocation of resources based on the diverse needs of students, classrooms, schools, and communities across BVSD. This work will support the BVSD Vision, Mission, Values Goals and the BVSD Strategic Plan.

#### **Membership:**

- Co-chairs: Nancy Piercy (Centaurus, SPED) / Lori Hattendorf (Bear Creek, 2nd grade) and Robbyn Fernandez (Executive Director for Elementary School Leadership)
- General Educators:  
Dan Laman (Centennial LA)  
Lori Hattendorf (Bear Creek, 2nd grade)  
Tina Mueh (BVEA President)
- Specialists:  
Alysia Hayas (Whittier, ELD/IB)  
Jacy Bruno (Mesa, PE)  
Beth Bogner (Centaurus, Reading)  
Carolyn Sclar (MK-8 Music)
- Building Administrators:  
Lora de la Cruz (Sánchez, Principal)  
Justin McMillan (Casey, Principal)  
Greg Guevara (Nederland, Assistant Principal)  
Don Stensrud (Fairview, Principal)
- Special Educators:  
Sally Lopez (Aspen Creek, Resource)

Sarah Hultgren (Manhattan, Resource)  
Stephen Solis (Boulder HS, ICAN)

- District Administrators:  
Dennis Rastatter (SPED)  
Steve Landrigan (HR)  
Bill Sutter (Business Services)  
Chris Wilderman (Custodians, Operations, Security)  
Cynthia Trinidad-Sheehan (ELD)
- Parents:  
Andrea Ritzer (parent-Boulder)  
Kathleen Marr (parent-Lafayette)

### **Summary of Committee Work:**

The Student Based Resource Allocations MOU committee met for 36 hours in half-day and full-day meetings for a period of over one year in order to arrive at the recommendations listed below. The committee began its work by creating vision and mission statements which served as guiding documents throughout the process. In addition, Bill Sutter (BVSD CFO), Gillian Luis (BVSD Budget Analyst), and Tracey Rainey (Colorado School Finance Project Director) presented information to the group on how schools in general are funded, BVSD school funding formulas, and differentiated school funding models. This provided baseline information for the committee and served as a springboard for the extensive process that the committee subsequently engaged in involving research of weighted student allocation models across the U.S.

The next step of the process was to look at the body of information and consider how the creation of funding priorities could and should align with the Success Effect and specifically, Multi-Tiered Systems of Support. Based on both research of funding models and mathematical calculation models using BVSD schools, the group determined that available funds (beyond current school FTE allocations) should be prioritized in the following way:

1. Students in poverty;
2. Students on IEPs;
3. Students who are learning English.

It is the belief of the Student Based Resource Allocations MOU committee that the allocation of resources to schools based on these priorities will provide schools with additional resources needed to improve outcomes for our most at-risk students while maintaining current levels of funding that support all students in BVSD. The group completed a consensus decision-making process, achieving consensus on the recommendation statement and implementation guidelines below.

## **Guiding Principles:**

### Vision:

Our vision is to create a culture where parents, teachers, staff, students, administrators, and community members will embrace all of BVSD as one community. The positive feelings people have for their school will extend to our district as a whole. We believe that all students should be allocated the appropriate resources to meet their diverse needs so that they can access the curriculum and learn through highly effective instruction. The overall goal is to further student success, with the intention of making them lifelong learners.

### Mission:

Our mission is to create a system that would be sustainable, fiscally possible, transparent, flexible, manageable and research-based. We will complete an analysis of our current allocation model and identify any areas that are not aligned with our BVSD Vision, Mission, Values and Goals in the Strategic Plan. With an understanding that equitable is not the same as equal, we will identify inequity that exists in our district; we will make suggestions for correcting any misalignments; while avoiding incentivizing the unnecessary labeling of students, we will create a research-based, basic student allocation framework to support an equitable playing field.

## **Student Based Resource Allocations MOU Committee Recommendations and Implementation Guidelines:**

### Recommendation:

**Further funding available beyond what is necessary to maintain current levels of services, including maintaining the current staffing ratios, shall be allocated:**

- 1. Up to the first \$1.5M will be divided among schools based on the number of students with a FRL designation.**
- 2. Funds beyond the initial \$1.5M and up to an additional \$1.5M will be divided among schools based on the number of students with a SPED designation.**
- 3. Funds beyond the initial \$3M and up to an additional \$1.5M will be divided among schools based on the number of students with an ELD designation.**

### Implementation Guidelines:

The allocation of these additional resources in the form of “Teacher FTE” is intended to allow for flexibility of program design and implementation. It is understood that the conversion between position types may result in budget dollars shifting between major programmatic areas as annual decisions are made regarding the use of targeted resources.

- Resources are allocated to schools annually in the form of Regular Ed Teacher FTE based on the prior year's October Count data.
- Existing parameters for FTE conversions apply in the use of these additional funds.
- While this child-centered funding model is intended to support students in specific categories, the outcome of strategies implemented may, as a secondary effect, benefit the entire school population.
- Use of additional resources will be determined through shared decision making and aligned with the strategies developed collaboratively as part of the UIP, therefore accountability measures for use of these funds are embedded within the UIP.

**Further Considerations:**

- Minimize barriers for families to receive FRL status and services.
- To improve efficiencies and increase understanding and trust, promote transparency and information sharing about the allocation and use of resources in schools.